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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) –

MG1DSCJMC100, MG1DSCPJM101 -INTRODUCTION TO COMMUNICATION

(2024 ADMISION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C),

Skill(S), Interest(I) andAppreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A Multiple Choice Questions Answer All Questions Each Question carries 1 mark

1. Distinguish between the sender and receiver in the communication process

b). The sender encodes the message

2. Which of the following is NOT one of the primary elements in Aristotle's Model of Communication?

c) Feedback

3. Identify a key function of communication

a). Social interaction

4. Which of the following is an example of kinesic communication?

b).Nodding the head during a conversation

5. In Aristotle's Model of Communication, the 'occasion' refers to:

B). The context or situation in which the communication takes place

6. A news broadcast that transmits information to millions of viewers without direct audience

participation is an example of:

a). Mass communication

7. Which of the following is an example of a physical barrier in communication?

a). Noise from the Microphone

8. What is semiotics primarily the study of?

b). The study of signs and symbols and their use or interpretation in communication

9. Which of the following is an example of nonverbal communication?

c). Facial expressions

10. Areapagetica was first proposed by

a). John Milton

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions Answer any 10 Questions. Each Question carries 3 marks

11. Compare verbal and non-verbal communication, highlighting their strengths and weakness.

Verbal communication uses spoken or written words to convey clear, direct messages, making it effective for detailed explanations and complex ideas. It can be limited by language barriers and may fail to express emotions fully. Non-verbal communication (gestures, facial expression etc) adds emotional depth and can reinforce or contradict verbal messages. It may be misinterpreted across cultures or lack precision without accompanying words.

12. Compare the social functions of communication in mass media versus interpersonal

communication

Mass media communication serves broad societal functions such as informing the public, shaping opinions, and reinforcing cultural norms on a large scale. In

contrast, interpersonal communication fosters personal relationships, emotional support, and mutual understanding between individuals or small groups. While mass media influences collective behaviour and public opinion, interpersonal communication builds trust and intimacy in everyday social life.

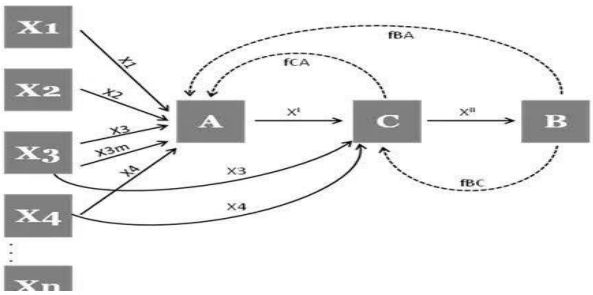
13. Write a note on triangular model of communication

Aristotle's triangular model of communication—also known as the rhetorical triangle—consists of three key elements: ethos (credibility), pathos (emotion), and logos (logic). The triangular model of communication illustrates the dynamic relationship between the sender, receiver, and message,

14. Narrate the importance of Westley and MacLean's model

Westley and MacLean's model emphasizes the dynamic and cyclical nature of communication, especially in mass media contexts. It highlights how communication begins with environmental events, which are selected and shaped by gatekeepers before reaching the audience. This model is crucial for understanding how media filters information and how feedback loops influence public discourse

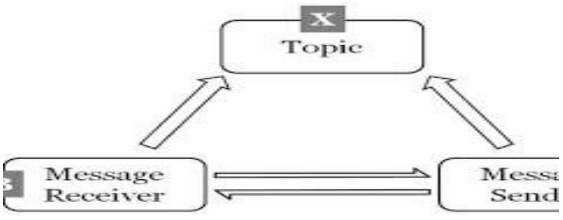
Westley and MacLean's Model of Communication



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15. Discuss the importance of ABX Model

The ABX model of communication, developed by Theodore Newcomb, focuses on the role of shared attitudes in effective communication. It involves three components: A (the sender), B (the receiver), and X (the subject or object of communication). The model emphasizes that communication is successful when A and B share a similar orientation or attitude toward X, fostering mutual understanding and social harmony.



The Newcomb's Model

16. Discuss the concepts base and superstructure

In Marxist theory, the concepts of base and superstructure describe how economic foundations shape and are shaped by cultural, political, and ideological institutions. The base refers to the material and economic conditions of society, while the superstructure encompasses its ideas, institutions, and social relations.

17. What is Agenda Setting Theory

Agenda Setting Theory posits that media doesn't tell people what to think, but rather what to think about. By emphasizing certain issues over others, media outlets shape public perception of what topics are important. This theory, developed by Maxwell McCombs and Donald Shaw, highlights the media's powerful role in influencing political discourse and public priorities.

18. Discuss the relevance of Uses and Gratification Theory?

Uses and Gratification Theory remains highly relevant today as it explains how individuals actively choose media to satisfy specific needs such as information, entertainment, social interaction, or personal identity. In the age of digital media and social platforms, this theory helps us understand why users engage with certain content

19. What are the qualities assigned to the sender and receiver in SMCR model?

In the SMCR model (Source-Message-Channel-Receiver), the sender is characterized by **communication skills, attitude, knowledge, social system, and culture**—all of which influence how effectively the message is encoded. The receiver shares similar attributes: their ability to decode the message depends on their own communication skills, attitude, knowledge, social background, and cultural context. This model emphasizes that successful communication occurs when the sender and receiver have overlapping fields of experience.

20. Discuss the concept Global village

The concept of the Global Village, coined by media theorist Marshall McLuhan, describes how electronic media collapse space and time barriers, making the world feel smaller and more interconnected. As communication technologies enable real-time interaction across continents, people experience global events as if they were local. This interconnectedness fosters cultural exchange, economic interdependence, and shared consciousness, but also raises concerns about homogenization and digital divides.

21. Discuss syntagmatic relations

Syntagmatic relations refer to the way linguistic elements are organized in a linear sequence to create meaning—such as words in a sentence or sounds in a word. These elements co-occur and depend on their position relative to one another; for example, in the phrase "the black cat," changing the order alters the meaning.

22. What are the two parts of a sign

In semiotics, a sign consists of two parts: the signifier and the signified. The signifier is the physical form of the sign—such as a word, image, or sound—while

the signified is the concept or meaning it represents. Together, they form a unit of meaning.

Part C

Essay Type Questions Answer any 2 Questions Each Question carries 15 marks

23. Describe the 7Cs of Communication and their importance in effective communication

The 7 Cs of Communication—Clarity, Continuity, Conciseness, Correctness, Coherence, Completeness, and Credibility—serve as essential principles for crafting effective communication. A clear message avoids ambiguity, while concise communication eliminates unnecessary words, saving time and enhancing impact. Concrete and correct information ensures accuracy and credibility specificity, building trust with the audience.

Any seven words that start with the letter C and represent qualities that enhance effective communication can be included.

24. Associate communication barriers with the 7Cs of Communication

Explain the types of communication barriers and connect them with the 7 Cs of communication. Communication barriers often arise when one or more of the 7 Cs are neglected. Lack of clarity can lead to misunderstanding, especially when messages are vague or overly complex. Absence of conciseness may overwhelm the receiver with unnecessary details, creating confusion or disinterest. Incorrect information—whether factual or grammatical—damages credibility and trust, while discourtesy can trigger emotional resistance or conflict. Ensuring all 7 Cs are upheld helps minimize barriers and fosters effective, respectful, and impactful communication.

25. Marxian views on media revolve around the idea that media serves as a tool for the dominant class: Comment.

Marxian theory views media as an instrument of the ruling class, used to maintain and legitimize their dominance in capitalist societies. According to this perspective, media ownership is concentrated among the bourgeoisie, who control content to reflect and reinforce their ideology. This leads to the dissemination of messages that promote consumerism, justify inequality, and obscure class struggle, creating a false consciousness among the working class. Media thus functions not as a neutral platform, but as a tool of hegemony that shapes public opinion in favor of elite interests

26. Write a note on Media dependency theory and social learning theory

Media Dependency Theory suggests that the more people rely on media to understand their world, the more influence media has over their attitudes and behaviours. This dependency increases during times of social change or crisis, when individuals seek information to reduce uncertainty.

Social Learning Theory, developed by Albert Bandura, posits that people learn behaviours by observing others—especially through media representations. It

emphasizes the role of modelling, imitation, and reinforcement in shaping attitudes and actions. Together, these theories highlight how media not only informs but also educates and influences social behaviour through repeated exposure and perceived credibility.